

“Mozilla measures success by how much we are doing to improve the overall health of the open Web”

Mozilla's rapid release cycle for the Firefox browser has had corporations a bit worried for a long time. Many feel that the Mozilla Foundation should slow down a bit for users to get accustomed to the changes offered with each release. Mozilla, however, has a different take on this. While a lot has been happening at Mozilla, the foundation is also eyeing the mobile space with Boot To Gecko. But with a super successful open source software like Android around, is Boot To Gecko a cool move from Mozilla?

Diksha P Gupta from **Open Source For You** touched upon all these issues in an exclusive conversation with the **Mozilla Foundation**. Here are a few excerpts:

Q What are you doing to ensure that even companies adopt Firefox like individuals do?

Many organisations have two primary concerns: 1) The Firefox release schedule doesn't allow sufficient time for the organisations and their vendors to certify new releases of the products; 2) The associated end-of-life policy exposes them to considerable security risks if they remain on a non-current version past Firefox 3.6.

To help address these issues, Mozilla offers an Extended Support Release (ESR) based on an official release of Firefox for the desktop. This can be used by organisations including schools, universities and businesses, as well as by others who need extended support for mass deployments. To find out more information about this programme, please see Mozilla's ESR Overview.

Q Mozilla had to pull back Firefox 16 after its launch, amidst security concerns. What were they and how have you fixed them?

The security vulnerability in Firefox 16 could have allowed a malicious site to potentially determine which website's users had visited it and get access to the URL or URL parameters. There was no indication that this vulnerability was being exploited in the wild.

Mozilla worked quickly to fix the vulnerability, releasing updates to *Firefox for Android* on October 10 and *Firefox for Windows, Mac and Linux* on October 11.

Q The beta of Firefox 17 offers a new social API. There have been Mozilla APIs that did not get very far. Why did you feel the need to introduce one now?

Many people use social sites throughout the day—checking back for updates, chatting with friends and sharing. When we started to integrate social sites into Firefox, this was our guiding principle: make it easy to stay connected, and stop treating social like 'just another tab'. We see potential for

Social API integration beyond traditional social sites, too – imagine using the sidebar as an easy way to keep up with group projects, email, or new music. Mozilla is a non-profit organisation; we build Firefox only for users, and features like the Social API exist solely to give users a more integrated, human, awesome Web experience.

Q According to Statcounter, Chrome is the No 1 browser, followed by IE. What do you think Firefox lacks?

Mozilla measures success by how much we are doing to improve the overall health of the open Web. Mozilla achieves success by helping more people make choices about what software they want to use, what level of participation they would like to have online, and how to take part in building a better Internet. When we see growth in community contributors, software localisation, and a competitive browser market, for example, we know we are moving toward our goals.

Q Secure surfing is increasingly becoming a concern for one and all. How is Mozilla working to ensure security for its users?

Mozilla has incorporated some features in the Firefox browser, which help users ensure their online security. Here are a couple of them:

Warn me when sites try to install add-ons: Firefox will

